Updating HeartStor ChMS

Overview

Updating **HeartStor ChMS** to the latest version is quick and straightforward. When a new version is released, you simply download the latest installer from the website and install it over your existing installation.

The installer will update the program files while **preserving all existing data, church databases, and system configurations**.

Before You Begin

Before updating the system, it is recommended that you:

- Ensure all users have **closed HeartStor ChMS**
- Perform a **backup of your database** as a precaution
- Confirm the **installation folder location** of your current system

Backing up your data ensures that you can easily restore your system if needed.

Step 1: Download the Latest Version

1. Visit the HeartStor ChMS website.
2. Download the latest installer package.
3. Save the installer file to your computer.

The website always provides the **most recent version** of the system.

Step 2: Run the Installer

1. Locate the downloaded installation file.
2. **Right-click the installer and select "Run as Administrator."**
3. The installation wizard will start.

Step 3: Select the Existing Installation Folder

When prompted to select the installation folder:

- Choose the **same folder where your current HeartStor ChMS is installed**.

Example:

```
C:\HeartStor
```

Installing into the same folder allows the installer to **update the existing program files**.

Step 4: Complete the Update

1. Click **Install** to begin the update.
2. The installer will replace the necessary program files.
3. Your **church databases, settings, and configurations will remain unchanged**.

Once the installation is complete, click **Finish**.

Step 5: Start the Updated Version

After the update:

1. Launch **HeartStor ChMS** from the desktop shortcut or installation folder.
2. Log in as usual.

The system will now be running the **latest version**.

Important Notes

- Updating the software **does not delete or modify your church data**.
- Always install updates into the **same folder as the existing installation**.
- Ensure that **no users are running the program during the update** in multi-user environments.

Best Practice

It is recommended to **regularly check the website for updates** to ensure your system benefits from the latest improvements, fixes, and enhancements.